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Search Committee
Department of Economics
Miami Herbert Business School
University of Miami
Coral Gables, FL 33146
USA

Dear Members of the Search Committee,

I am writing to express my interest in the Assistant/Associate/Full Professor position in Economics at the Miami Herbert Business School at the University of Miami, beginning in 2026. I am a Ph.D. candidate in Economics at Johns Hopkins University, advised by Professors Christopher D. Carroll, Nicholas W. Papageorge, and Stelios Fourakis, and I expect to receive my degree in May 2026. My research fields are macroeconomics, wealth and income dynamics, and computational economics.

My research agenda focuses on understanding the determinants of wealth inequality and the mechanisms through which heterogeneity in returns to wealth shapes aggregate outcomes. In my job-market paper, I estimate the degree of heterogeneity in individual portfolio returns using micro-data from the Survey of Consumer Finances and simulate a structural model in which households face idiosyncratic return risk. I show that allowing for persistent heterogeneity in returns substantially improves the model's ability to match the empirical distribution of wealth, offering a tractable way to connect micro-level return dispersion to macroeconomic inequality.

In a second project, I use the Health and Retirement Study to examine the relationship between interpersonal trust and portfolio performance. Building on the literature that finds a hump-shaped relationship between trust and income, I show that a similar relationship holds for individual returns to wealth measured in the HRS data, highlighting a behavioral channel through which social attitudes shape saving and investment outcomes. This work also provides new estimates of the persistent component of returns to net worth, which motivate the calibration of heterogeneity in my structural model.

Miami Herbert Business School's commitment to rigorous, data-driven research on topics such as macroeconomics, finance, and applied econometrics aligns closely with my work on heterogeneous returns, household portfolios, and inequality. My empirical and computational approach naturally connects to business and policy questions around capital allocation, financial stability, and distributional impacts of macroeconomic shocks and tax policy. I am excited about the opportunity to collaborate with faculty and students across economics, finance, and related fields in an environment that values both high-quality research and its implications for business practice and public policy.

Teaching. My teaching experience centers on undergraduate macroeconomics and an upper-level macro policy seminar, where I have led weekly discussion sections and held regular office hours for classes ranging from 16 to 40 students. My approach is student-centered: I aim to help students

“convince themselves” that they have moved from confusion to understanding by holding structured office-hour coaching that builds trust and confidence. At Miami Herbert, I am prepared to teach *Principles of Macroeconomics*, *Intermediate Macroeconomic Theory*, *Money and Banking*, and *Quantitative Methods for Economics*. I would also welcome developing electives such as *Economics of Inequality and Tax Policy* or *Computational Macroeconomics and Policy*, emphasizing reproducible workflows and evidence-based decision-making using modern statistical and computational tools.

I believe I would be a strong fit because my computational and empirical toolkit allows me to (i) produce robust, data-backed estimates of returns and distributional outcomes, (ii) build and validate models that speak to macroeconomic, financial, and policy-relevant questions, and (iii) collaborate effectively with faculty and students in a research-active business school environment. I am enthusiastic about the opportunity to contribute to the Miami Herbert Business School’s teaching, research, and service missions.

I would be honored to join the Department of Economics at the Miami Herbert Business School and to mentor students pursuing quantitative careers in economics, finance, and related fields. Thank you for your consideration; I welcome the opportunity to discuss my fit with your program at your convenience.

Sincerely,

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